

Song Lab

Hear chords, build beats, and map your song. Scan the code or type:

cmfnyc.github.io/song-lab/



Song Anatomy Map

Every section has a job

- **Intro** — Sets the mood. Says "a song is starting." Often just chords or a riff.
- **Verse** — Tells the story. Same melody every time, **new words** every time.
- **Pre-chorus** (optional) — Builds up. Makes you feel "something big is coming."
- **Chorus** — The main idea and usually the **title**. Same melody **and** same words every time. The biggest part.
- **Post-chorus** (optional) — A short, catchy add-on after the chorus. Often just "oh-oh" or one word.
- **Bridge** — Something **different**, usually once, near the end. New chords, new angle.
- **Outro** — The ending. Fades out, or stops on a big hit.

The hook is the part that gets stuck in your head. Usually a short phrase in the chorus. Sometimes it's an instrument riff.

The most common pop shape

Verse → Chorus → Verse → Chorus → Bridge → Chorus

With extras: Intro → Verse → Pre-chorus → Chorus → Verse → Pre-chorus → Chorus → Bridge → Chorus → Outro

What changes when the chorus arrives?

Listen and check every one you hear:

- ☐ It gets louder
- ☐ The melody goes higher

- ☐ More instruments come in
- ☐ The drums change
- ☐ The title is sung
- ☐ The words repeat
- ☐ Other: _____

These are the tools **you** will use in your own song.

Listening Map

Song: _____ **Artist:** _____

Tempo guess: slow / medium / fast **Mood in one word:** _____

Write each section as it happens.

1. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
2. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
3. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
4. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
5. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
6. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
7. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____
8. Time _____ Section _____ What I notice _____

The hook (5 words or fewer): _____

How many times does the hook repeat in one chorus? _____

One thing I want to steal for my song (a structure, a sound, a trick — not the melody or words):
